D.J. PARIS

A SALES SLUMP DOESN'T MAKE AGENTS LEAVE.

A new study tracked why producers actually switch brokerages, and a bad quarter wasn't one of the reasons.

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EIGHT THINGS PUSH AN AGENT TO LEAVE. A BAD QUARTER ISN'T ONE OF THEM.

A new study of over 100,000 producing agents found the real signal has nothing to do with your numbers.

THE REAL SIGNAL ISN'T YOUR NUMBERS. IT'S THESE EIGHT THINGS.

A Q3 2026 study of 109,176 producing agents (Recruiting Insight, with Lone Wolf Technologies) found a production drop of more than 25% made no difference to whether an agent left their brokerage. Compensation ranked first among eight reasons agents actually switch, ahead of leadership direction, agent protection and support, training, differentiation, technology, culture, and overall dissatisfaction. Agents already showing three or four of those eight warning signs were 1.8 times more likely to move.

DO THIS, NOT THAT:

1 **Don't wait for a slow quarter to ask if you're in the right place.**
A production drop wasn't even a factor in the data.

2 **Don't rank the split above everything else.**
Compensation topped the list, but leadership, support, and training all made the top eight too.

3 **Don't guess at your own risk.**
Count how many of the eight factors apply to you right now.

4 **Don't assume independent is a downgrade.**
53 percent of agents leaving national brands moved to independent firms last quarter.

THE TAKEAWAY

SCORE YOUR BROKERAGE AGAINST THE EIGHT FACTORS THIS WEEK, NOT AFTER A BAD QUARTER.

Compensation, leadership, protection, training, differentiation, technology, culture, overall fit.

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